



SEX & AGING

NURS 280 JUNE 9, 2026



Centrum ad



Safer Sex 4 Seniors video



Still images



WHAT ARE SENIORS UP TO?

- They say that sex is important to them
- Most are sexually active
- Sometimes sex is better for seniors
- Physical well-being is tied to sex



“Remarkably few scientific studies address sexual behavior in mid- and later life or the ways in which sexuality changes over the life course. “

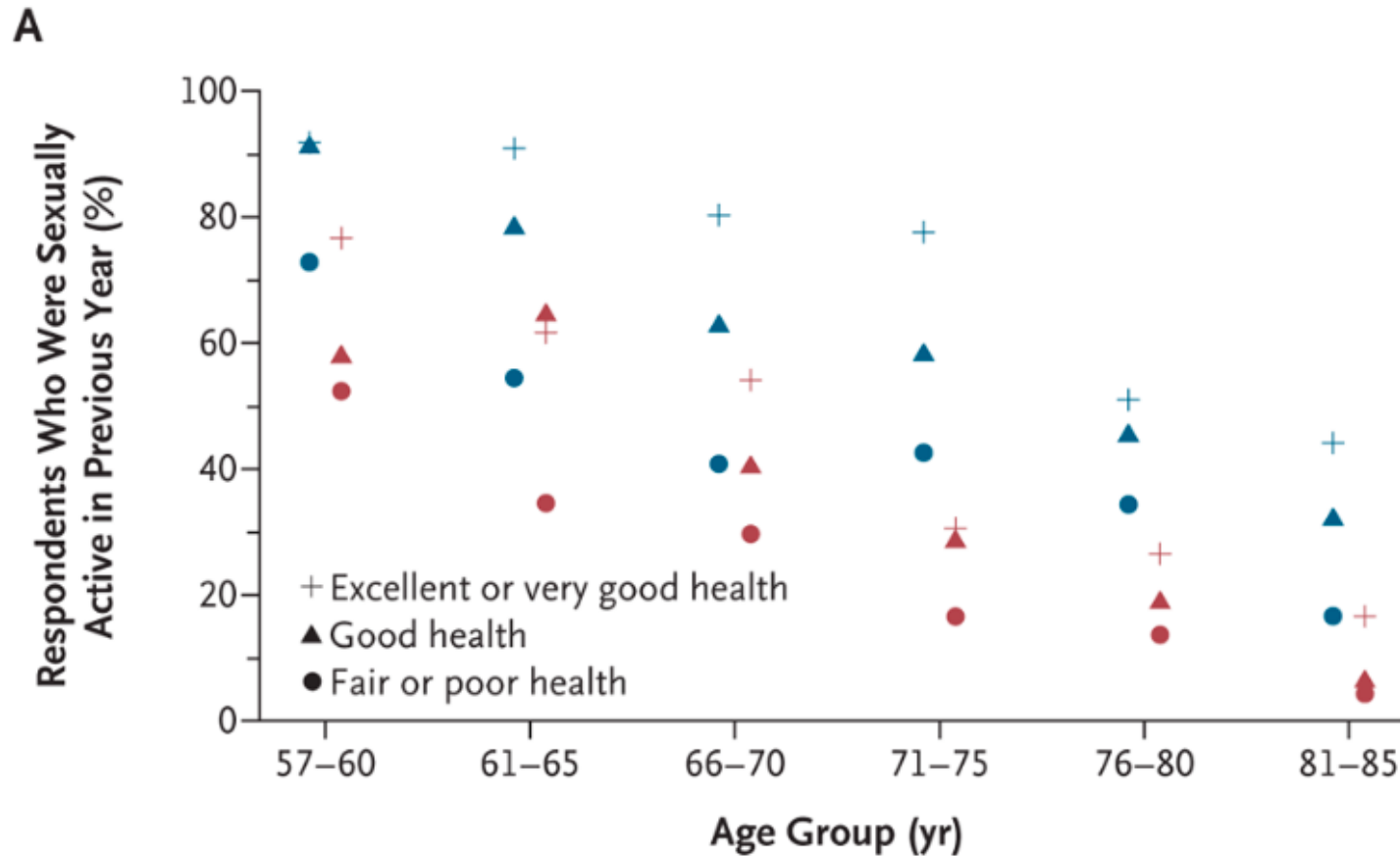
DeLamater & Moorman, 2007

“Despite the aging of the population, little is known about the sexual behaviors and sexual function of older people.”

Lindau, et al., 2007



FINDINGS



Lindau, S.T., et al. (2007)



SEX: THE BENEFITS

- Use it or lose it!
- More intimacy, more touch
- Longer, healthier lives
- Endorphin release
- Exercise



SEX: THE CHALLENGES

Cis women:

- Lower estrogen (libido changes, thinning tissues)



Cis men:

- Lower testosterone (erectile changes, prostate issues)

All Genders:

- STIs, dating again, limits imposed by others (family, long-term care facilities, etc.)

Consent & aging

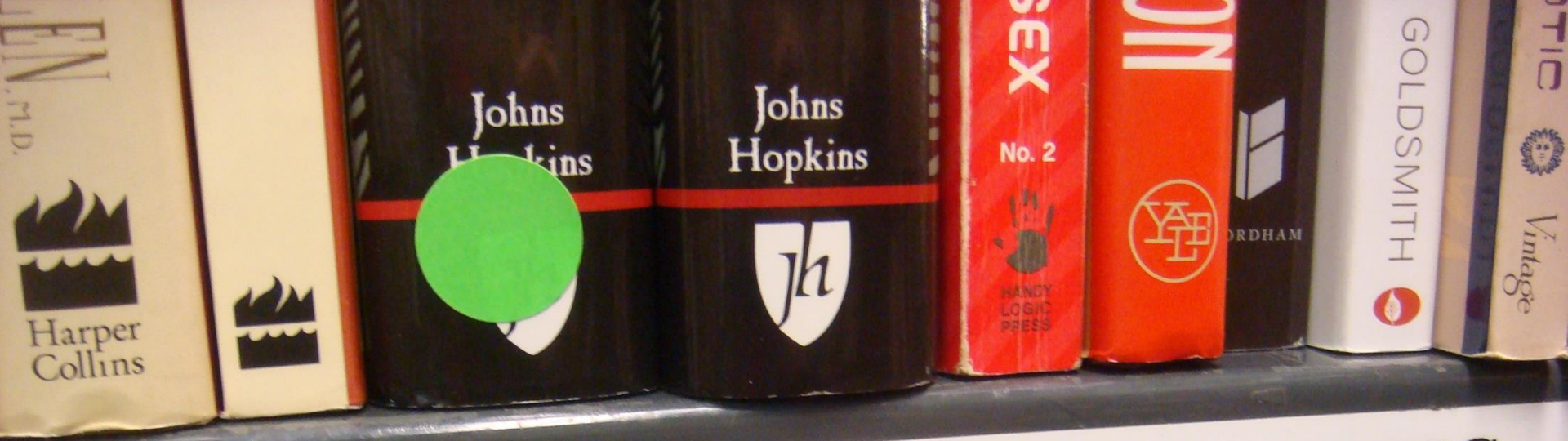


CRITERIA FOR SEXUAL CONSENT

- Basic sexual knowledge
- Ability to understand consequences and risk
- Ability to understand appropriate and inappropriate locations and times for sexual activity.
- Ability to articulate choice, preferences, and resistance
- Ability to recognize distress or resistance in a partner

VCH Authority, 2009





SEXUALITY CONTINUES



THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

